COMMERCIAL & TECHNOLOGY AUDIT

Farmer's Best International

Fresh Produce Grower-Shipper & Importer · Nogales, AZ / McAllen, TX

A commercial & technology audit quantifying where margin leaks in a razor-thin perishables business — and how to recover it on top of what you already run.

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Systems Consulting B2B · CRM · Automation · AI · August 2026

01 Executive summary

Farmer's Best International is a vertically integrated grower-shipper-importer of fresh produce run by the Tarriba family: they grow in Sinaloa/Sonora (Agrícola Tarriba), import through Nogales, AZ and McAllen, TX, and distribute tomatoes, peppers, cucumbers, grapes, mangoes and melons to retail, foodservice and wholesale across the US and Canada. ~50 years growing, ~30 distributing, with 95,000 + 24,000 sq ft of cold storage and an owned fleet. Its CEO chaired the FPAA (2020-2022).

For its size and industry weight, the digital layer is thin: a dated .com.mx website (SSL currently failing), no customer portal or e-commerce, and orders by phone/email. In a razor-thin-margin perishables business, that manual layer is where money leaks — to shrink, mis-picks and temperature claims. Figures are illustrative estimates, to confirm in the audit.

ESTIMATED LEAK (illustrative · to confirm in the audit)

Margin lost to perishable shrink and mis-picks on manual phone/email orders, plus regulatory exposure (FSMA 204 traceability) and fuel/claims from an unoptimized cold-chain fleet — across a two-state operation.

› Thousands of pallets of short-shelf-life produce with no real-time, lot-level visibility → shrink hits margin directly.
› Order capture by phone/email → double entry, mis-picks and invoicing errors.
› FSMA 204 lot traceability likely on paper/Excel → hours and recall/audit risk.
› Illustrative figures; the exact number comes from their data in the audit.

02 Business model — how they make money

- **What they do:** grow, import and distribute fresh produce (tomato, pepper, cucumber, grape, mango, melon).
- **Who they serve:** retail (supermarkets), foodservice/restaurants and wholesalers across the US and Canada.
- **Coverage:** import hubs in Rio Rico, AZ and McAllen/Edinburg, TX; farms in Mexico; owned fleet (USDOT 2368074).
- **Scale:** ~50 yrs; cold storage 95,000 sq ft/3,200 pallets (AZ) + 24,000 sq ft/1,400 pallets (TX). Family-owned; CEO ex-FPAA Chairman.

03 How they get customers

- Orders by phone/email to individual reps (@farmersbest.us / .com.mx); typical of the trade.
- Dated .com.mx website (SSL failing), no customer portal or e-commerce.
- Active on Facebook; thin LinkedIn presence; no visible internal IT.

04 Digital presence & tech observed

PUBLIC SOURCES ONLY · WHAT CAN'T BE VERIFIED IS MARKED «NOT OBSERVABLE»

TOOL	STATUS	OBSERVATION
Website (.com.mx)	Confirmed (dated)	SSL certificate error on load; informational, not commercial.
Customer portal / e-commerce	Not found	No self-service ordering.
Order taking	Confirmed (manual)	Phone/email to individual reps.
Produce ERP (Famous/Silo?)	Not observable	Likely a produce ERP or Excel + separate accounting; to confirm.
Traceability (FSMA 204)	Not observable	Lot traceability likely on paper/Excel.
Internal IT / LinkedIn	Not found	No visible tech roles.

05 Where they're losing money

LEAK POINTS DETECTED FROM OBSERVABLE SIGNALS

- 100% manual order capture (phone/email) → double entry, mis-picks, invoicing errors.
- Perishable shrink → 4,600 pallets of short-life produce with no FIFO/lot visibility → product dies unsold.
- FSMA 204 traceability on paper/Excel → regulatory risk + hours in audits/recalls.
- Owned fleet with no route optimization or temperature telemetry → fuel, rejections, claims.
- Two-state / bi-national ops (AZ + TX + MX) with no unified inventory → misalignment, tied-up capital.
- No CRM → customers who reduce volume go unnoticed.

06 Prioritized opportunities

BY ECONOMIC IMPACT AND EASE OF IMPLEMENTATION

OPPORTUNITY	WHAT IT SOLVES	IMPACT	PRIORITY
Order-capture portal	Buyers order from live availability; fewer errors	More sales / hours	VERY HIGH
Real-time inventory + shrink forecast	Prioritize dispatch before product dies	Margin recovery	VERY HIGH
Automated FSMA 204 traceability	Compliance + recalls in minutes	Less risk	HIGH
Cold-chain + route optimization	Fewer rejections and fuel; temp alerts	Logistics savings	HIGH
Unified AZ↔TX inventory + CRM	One view across two states; catch dormant buyers	Control	MEDIUM

07 Leak quantification (CFO view)

ESTIMATE WITH ASSUMPTIONS · INVESTMENT IN TIERS ($ low · $$ mid · $$$ high), TO BE DEFINED

PROBLEM	IMPACT	EST. ANNUAL COST	SOLUTION	IN V.
Manual order capture	Errors + mis-picks	Variable (high volume)	Order-capture portal	$ $
Perishable shrink	Product dies unsold	Direct margin hit	Inventory + forecast	$ $
FSMA 204 on paper/Excel	Hours + recall risk	Variable + risk	Automated traceability	$ $
Unoptimized cold-chain fleet	Fuel + temp claims	Variable	Route + temp telemetry	$
Dormant buyers	Lost recurring revenue	Variable	CRM + alerts	$

08 Hidden opportunities (AI & data)

WHAT ALMOST NO CONSULTANCY LOOKS AT

- Demand & shrink prediction from sales + arrivals + shelf-life to dynamic-price before product dies.
- Automated FSMA lot capture (labels/scan at receiving) → recalls in minutes, not days.
- Cold-chain telemetry + smart routing → fewer temperature rejections and lower fuel.

09 What we cover in the free audit

INTERNAL AREAS AREN'T PUBLIC — THIS IS THE NO-COST DISCOVERY

- How orders are captured and entered today across AZ and TX.
- What produce ERP/system runs the operation and what's disconnected.
- How lot traceability (FSMA 204) is handled today.
- Where shrink and temperature claims originate.
- From that: the exact $ leak and a phased ROI roadmap.

10 Phased proposal

Approach: **build on top of what exists**, highest impact and lowest effort first.

PHASE 1 · VERY HIGH — Capture & inventory

Order-capture portal + real-time inventory with shrink/demand forecast.

PHASE 2 · HIGH — Compliance & cold-chain

Automated FSMA 204 traceability + route/temperature optimization.

PHASE 3 · MEDIUM — Unify & grow

Unified AZ↔TX inventory + CRM for dormant buyers.

11 Entry angle

> *«Farmer's Best moves thousands of pallets of highly perishable produce on phone-and-email orders across two states — every hour a lot sits untracked is margin lost to shrink, mis-picks or a temperature claim. I help produce importers plug those leaks (order capture, lot traceability, cold-chain visibility) on top of the systems you already run, without ripping anything out.»*

12 Arguments for decision-makers

CEO (Leonardo Tarriba): Protect margin on perishables and de-risk FSMA 204 — building on the operation you've grown for 50 years.

CFO: Less shrink, fewer temperature claims and fewer invoicing errors; measurable savings on high volume.

VP Sales (Stephen Yubeta): Buyers order from live availability; reps stop chasing and the team catches dormant accounts.

13 Summary: findings & solutions

AREA	FINDING	SOLUTION
Orders	Phone/email, manual	Order-capture portal
Inventory	No real-time/lot view; shrink	Inventory + shrink forecast
Compliance	FSMA 204 on paper/Excel	Automated lot traceability
Logistics	Fleet, no route/temp control	Cold-chain + route optimization
Customers	Dormant buyers unnoticed	CRM + alerts

14 Conclusion

Farmer's Best has the hard part: 50 years, vertical integration, cold storage and industry leadership. What holds it back is a thin digital layer running a razor-thin-margin perishables business by phone and paper.

Order capture, inventory intelligence, automated traceability and cold-chain visibility — built on top of what they run — is low-risk, high-return, because in perishables every point of shrink is pure margin.

Let's start with a no-cost initial audit

We map your real process and hand you the exact $ leak and an ROI roadmap. No obligation.

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CRM · ERP · Dashboards · Automation · AI Solutions

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